

Word family: **aim / aims / aimed / aiming / aimless / aimlessly / aimlessness / well-aimed**

Base word: aim

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

aim (n.) — 目標；目的；瞄準

aim (v.) — 以.....為目標；力求；瞄準；針對

aimed (adj./participle) — 針對.....的；以.....為目標的；瞄準的

aiming (gerund/participle) — 旨在；瞄準中

aimless (adj.) — 漫無目的的；沒有方向的

aimlessly (adv.) — 漫無目的地

aimlessness (n.) — 漫無目的；缺乏方向

well-aimed (adj.) — 瞄得準的；針對得恰當的

Major useful extensions:

main aim, primary aim, overall aim, ultimate aim, long-term aim, short-term aim, common aim, shared aim, stated aim, clear aim, achieve an aim, fulfil an aim, pursue an aim, with the aim of, have the aim of, aim to do something, aim for something, aim at something, aim at doing something, be aimed at something, be aimed at doing something, aim something at someone, aim a product at a market, aim a remark at someone, aim criticism at someone, aim a weapon, aim at a target, take aim, take aim at, careful aim, good aim, poor aim, aim high, aim low, aim higher, aim toward/towards, well-aimed remark, aimless wandering, aimless conversation.

Meaning in this passage

> For instance, a product team may push for speed, while the compliance team insists on caution; without proper communication, these differing **aims** can delay the entire project.

Here, **aims** means:

the goals or outcomes that different teams are trying to achieve — 目標；目的

The product team wants:

> **speed**

while the compliance team wants:

> **caution / risk control**

Both have legitimate goals, but their **aims differ**.

****中文翻譯：****

例如，產品團隊可能力求加快進度，而合規團隊則堅持謹慎；如果缺乏適當溝通，這些不同的****目標 / 追求方向****可能會拖延整個項目。

So here:

****aim = 某人或團隊努力希望達成的目標或結果****

A. AIM = PURPOSE / GOAL

1. ****aim = purpose or goal — 目的；目標****

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> These differing ****aims**** can delay the entire project.

這些不同的****目標****可能會拖延整個項目。

Practice 2

> The team's main ****aim**** is to improve communication.

團隊的主要****目標****是改善溝通。

Practice 3

> Both departments have legitimate aims.

兩個部門都有合理的****目標****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****aim = 某人、團體或計劃希望最終達成的結果****

2. ****main aim — 主要目標****

Practice 1

> The ****main aim**** of the project is to reduce delays.

項目的****主要目標****是減少延誤。

Practice 2

> Our main aim is to improve customer satisfaction.

我們的****主要目標****是提高顧客滿意度。

3. ****primary aim — 首要目標****

Practice 1

> The ****primary aim**** is to improve safety.

****首要目標****是改善安全。

Practice 2

> The programme's primary aim is to support new employees.

計劃的****首要目的****是支援新員工。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****primary aim = 最重要、最優先希望達成的目標****

4. ****overall aim — 整體目標****

Practice 1

> The ****overall aim**** is to make teamwork more effective.

****整體目標****是提高團隊合作效率。

Practice 2

> Individual tasks should support the project's overall aim.

個別任務應配合項目的****整體目標****。

5. ****ultimate aim — 最終目標****

Practice 1

> The **ultimate aim** is long-term improvement.

最終目標是長遠改善。

Practice 2

> Profit is not the organisation's only ultimate aim.

盈利並不是該機構唯一的**最終目標**。

MCQ-ready definition:

ultimate aim = 經過其他中間步驟後最終真正希望達成的結果

6. **long-term aim — 長期目標**

Practice 1

> Our **long-term aim** is to expand internationally.

我們的**長期目標**是拓展國際市場。

Practice 2

> Training supports the company's long-term aims.

培訓有助實現公司的**長期目標**。

7. **short-term aim — 短期目標**

Practice 1

> The **short-term aim** is to clear the backlog.

短期目標是清理積壓工作。

Practice 2

> Short-term aims should support long-term strategy.

****短期目標**應配合長期策略。**

8. ****common aim — 共同目標****

Very relevant to teamwork.

Practice 1

> Successful teams work towards a ****common aim****.

成功團隊會朝着一個****共同目標****努力。

Practice 2

> Different departments need a common aim.

不同部門需要一個****共同目標****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****common aim = 多個人共同努力希望達成的同一目標****

9. ****shared aim — 共同目標****

Practice 1

> A ****shared aim**** can unite people with different priorities.

一個****共同目標****可以團結具有不同優先事項的人。

Practice 2

> The teams agreed on a shared aim.

各團隊就一個****共同目標****達成一致。

10. ****stated aim — 明示 / 正式列明的目標****

Practice 1

> The policy's ****stated aim**** is to reduce waste.

該政策**列明的目標**是減少浪費。

Practice 2

> The stated aim of the programme is employee development.

這項計劃**明確列出的目的**是員工發展。

MCQ-ready definition:

stated aim = 已公開或正式寫明的目標

11. **clear aim — 清晰目標**

Practice 1

> Teams work better when they have a **clear aim**.

團隊有**清晰目標**時通常合作得更好。

Practice 2

> Without a clear aim, people may work in different directions.

沒有**清晰目標**，人們可能會朝不同方向工作。

B. ACHIEVING / PURSUING AIMS

12. **achieve an aim — 達成目標**

Practice 1

> The team eventually **achieved its aim**.

團隊最終**達成了目標**。

Practice 2

> Clear roles help organisations achieve their aims.

清晰角色有助機構**實現目標**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****achieve an aim = 成功得到原本希望達成的結果****

13. ****fulfil an aim — 實現目標****

Practice 1

> The project fulfilled its main aim.

項目****實現了主要目標****。

Practice 2

> The programme failed to fulfil its stated aims.

計劃未能****實現已列明的目標****。

14. ****pursue an aim — 追求目標****

Practice 1

> The departments were ****pursuing different aims****.

各部門正在****追求不同目標****。

Practice 2

> Organisations may pursue several aims at once.

機構可能同時****追求多個目標****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****pursue an aim = 持續採取行動，希望達成某個目標****

15. ****work towards an aim — 朝目標努力****

Practice 1

> Everyone should work towards the same aim.

每個人都應該**朝同一目標努力**。

Practice 2

> The two teams are working towards a common aim.

兩個團隊正**朝共同目標前進**。

16. **meet an aim / objective — 達到目標**

Practice 1

> The programme met most of its aims.

這項計劃**達到了大部分目標**。

Practice 2

> Managers reviewed whether the stated aims had been met.

管理人員檢視已列明的目標是否**已經達到**。

C. WITH THE AIM OF

17. **with the aim of doing something — 旨在；目的是.....**

A major formal construction.

Practice 1

> The company introduced progress checks **with the aim of improving accountability**.

公司引入進度檢查，**旨在提高問責性**。

Practice 2

> The meeting was organised with the aim of resolving the conflict.

會議的安排**旨在解決衝突**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****with the aim of doing X = 以完成 X 為目的****

Grammar:

> ****with the aim of + noun/-ing****

not:

> ***with the aim to improve*** ⚠ less standard in careful formal English.

18. ****have the aim of doing something — 以.....為目標****

Practice 1

> The initiative ****has the aim of reducing delays****.

這項措施****以減少延誤為目標****。

Practice 2

> The course has the aim of improving workplace communication.

課程****旨在改善職場溝通****。

D. AIM TO DO

19. ****aim to do something — 力求 / 旨在做某事****

A major verb construction.

Practice 1

> The team ****aims to finish the project by Friday****.

團隊****力求在星期五前完成項目****。

Practice 2

> The policy aims to improve communication.

政策****旨在改善溝通****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****aim to do X = 計劃、打算並努力希望完成 X****

20. ****aim to achieve — 力求達成****

Practice 1

> We ****aim to achieve a balance between speed and caution****.

我們****力求在速度和謹慎之間取得平衡****。

Practice 2

> The company aims to achieve sustainable growth.

公司****力求實現可持續增長****。

21. ****aim to provide / reduce / improve — 旨在提供 / 減少 / 改善****

Practice 1

> The programme ****aims to provide better support****.

計劃****旨在提供更好的支援****。

Practice 2

> The changes aim to reduce confusion.

這些改變****旨在減少混亂****。

This construction is extremely common in:

- * reports,
- * essays,
- * policies,
- * IELTS writing.

E. AIM FOR

22. ****aim for something — 力求取得；以.....為目標****

Practice 1

> The team is **aiming for faster delivery**.

團隊正**力求更快交付**。

Practice 2

> We should **aim for a fairer distribution of work**.

我們應該**以更公平的工作分配為目標**。

MCQ-ready definition:

aim for X = 把 X 視為希望達到的結果

23. **aim for a target / result — 以某指標 / 成果為目標**

Practice 1

> The company is **aiming for 10% growth**.

公司**以百分之十增長為目標**。

Practice 2

> Students should aim for steady improvement.

學生應該**力求穩步進步**。

24. **aim for the top — 力爭最好 / 力爭第一**

Practice 1

> If you compete, **aim for the top**.

既然參賽，就**力爭最好成績**。

Practice 2

> The company is aiming for the top position in the market.

公司正**力爭市場第一的位置**。

F. AIM AT + GOAL / ACTIVITY

25. **aim at something — 以某事為目標**

Practice 1

> The reform **aims at greater efficiency**.

改革**以提高效率為目標**。

Practice 2

> The programme aims at long-term improvement.

這項計劃**旨在取得長期改善**。

MCQ-ready definition:

aim at X = 把 X 作為希望實現的目標

26. **aim at doing something — 旨在做某事**

Practice 1

> The policy **aims at reducing unnecessary delays**.

政策**旨在減少不必要的延誤**。

Practice 2

> The training aims at improving teamwork.

培訓**旨在改善團隊合作**。

Grammar:

> **aim at + noun/-ing**

27. **aim to do vs aim at doing**

Both are possible.

- > aim to improve communication
- > aim at improving communication

The first is generally more common and direct.

The second can sound slightly more formal.

G. BE AIMED AT = DESIGNED FOR A PURPOSE

28. **be aimed at doing something — 旨在做某事**

A major passive construction.

Practice 1

- > The new system is **aimed at reducing duplication**.

新系統**旨在減少重複工作**。

Practice 2

- > The training is aimed at improving communication.

培訓**旨在改善溝通**。

MCQ-ready definition:

be aimed at doing X = 某措施、計劃等的設計目的就是完成 X

29. **be aimed at a problem — 旨在處理某問題**

Practice 1

- > The measures are **aimed at the underlying causes of conflict**.

這些措施**針對衝突的根本原因**。

Practice 2

- > The policy is aimed at workplace inequality.

政策**針對職場不平等問題**。

H. AIM AT AN AUDIENCE / TARGET GROUP

30. **be aimed at someone — 針對某人 / 某群體而設**

A major marketing/communication sense.

Practice 1

> The programme is **aimed at new employees**.

這項計劃**針對新員工而設**。

Practice 2

> The advertisement is aimed at younger consumers.

這個廣告**以較年輕消費者為目標客群**。

MCQ-ready definition:

be aimed at X = 專門設計給 X 使用、觀看或接受

31. **aim a product at a market — 把產品定位於某市場**

Practice 1

> The product is **aimed at the premium market**.

產品**針對高端市場**。

Practice 2

> The company aimed the service at small businesses.

公司把這項服務**定位給小型企業**。

32. **aim advertising at a group — 把廣告針對某群體**

Practice 1

> The campaign is **aimed at young professionals**.

宣傳活動**針對年輕專業人士**。

Practice 2

> Advertising should be aimed at the right audience.

廣告應該**針對合適的目標受眾**。

33. **aim something at children / adults / beginners** — **針對某群體設計**

Practice 1

> The book is **aimed at beginners**.

這本書**是為初學者而寫的**。

Practice 2

> The course is aimed at working adults.

課程**以在職成年人為對象**。

I. DIRECT WORDS / CRITICISM AT SOMEONE

34. **aim a remark at someone** — **把說話針對某人**

Practice 1

> The comment seemed to be **aimed at the manager**.

那句話似乎是**針對經理說的**。

Practice 2

> She aimed a sarcastic remark at him.

她**針對他說了一句諷刺的話**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****aim a remark at someone = 刻意把某句話指向某人，通常希望對方感受到或回應****

35. ****aim criticism at someone — 把批評指向某人****

Practice 1

> Much of the criticism was ****aimed at senior management****.

大部分批評都****針對高層管理****。

Practice 2

> He aimed his criticism at the process rather than individuals.

他把批評****針對程序，而不是個人****。

36. ****aim an accusation / attack at someone — 把指控 / 攻擊指向某人****

Practice 1

> The accusation was ****aimed at the wrong person****.

這項指控****針對錯了人****。

Practice 2

> Most of the verbal attacks were aimed at management.

大部分言語攻擊都****針對管理層****。

J. LITERAL AIMING: WEAPON / OBJECT

37. ****aim a weapon — 瞄準武器****

A completely separate physical sense.

Practice 1

> He ****aimed the camera carefully****.

他小心地**把相機對準目標**。

Practice 2

> The officer aimed the weapon at the target.

警員把武器**瞄準目標**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****aim something = 把武器、相機、光線等對準某一特定方向或目標****

38. ****aim at a target — 瞄準目標****

Practice 1

> She ****aimed at the centre of the target****.

她****瞄準靶心****。

Practice 2

> Aim carefully before releasing the arrow.

放箭前先仔細****瞄準****。

39. ****aim a gun / rifle — 瞄準槍械****

Practice 1

> The rifle was ****aimed at the target****.

步槍被****瞄準靶子****。

Practice 2

> He raised the rifle and aimed.

他舉起步槍並****瞄準****。

40. **aim a camera — 把相機對準**

Practice 1

> She **aimed the camera at the stage**.

她把相機**對準舞台**。

Practice 2

> Aim the camera slightly higher.

把相機**稍微向上對準**。

This is not “aim” in the purpose sense; it is physical direction.

41. **aim a beam / light — 把光束對準**

Practice 1

> He **aimed the torch at the ceiling**.

他把電筒**照向天花板**。

Practice 2

> Aim the laser away from people's eyes.

不要把雷射光**對準人的眼睛**。

K. TAKE AIM

42. **take aim — 瞄準**

Practice 1

> She **took aim** and fired.

她**瞄準**後開槍。

Practice 2

> The archer took careful aim.

弓箭手仔細**瞄準**。

MCQ-ready definition:

take aim = 準備射擊或投擲前仔細對準目標

43. **take aim at something — 瞄準某物**

Practice 1

> He **took aim at the target**.

他**瞄準靶子**。

Practice 2

> The player took aim at the goal.

球員**瞄準球門**。

44. **careful aim — 仔細瞄準**

Practice 1

> He took **careful aim** before shooting.

他射擊前**仔細瞄準**。

Practice 2

> Accurate shooting requires careful aim.

準確射擊需要**仔細瞄準**。

L. AIM = ABILITY TO HIT A TARGET

45. **good aim — 瞄得準；準繩度高**

Practice 1

> She has **good aim**.

她**瞄得很準**。

Practice 2

> His good aim helped him hit the target.

他的**準繩度很好**，所以擊中了目標。

MCQ-ready definition:

aim = 對準並擊中目標的能力或準確程度

46. **poor / bad aim — 瞄準不準**

Practice 1

> His **aim was poor**.

他的**瞄準不準**。

Practice 2

> Poor aim caused the ball to miss the target.

因為**方向控制不準**，球沒有擊中目標。

47. **steady aim — 穩定瞄準**

Practice 1

> Keep a **steady aim**.

保持**穩定的瞄準方向**。

Practice 2

> A steady aim is important in archery.

射箭時**穩定瞄準**非常重要。

M. TAKE AIM AT = CRITICIZE / ATTACK FIGURATIVELY

48. **take aim at someone/something — 抨擊；把矛頭指向**

A major figurative idiom.

Practice 1

> The report **takes aim at poor management practices**.

報告**把矛頭指向管理不善的做法**。

Practice 2

> Critics took aim at the company's lack of transparency.

批評者**猛烈批評公司缺乏透明度**。

MCQ-ready definition:

take aim at X = figurative: 把批評、攻擊或挑戰集中在 X 身上

49. **take aim at a policy / practice — 抨擊政策 / 做法**

Practice 1

> The article **takes aim at outdated workplace practices**.

文章**批評過時的職場做法**。

Practice 2

> Campaigners took aim at the regulation.

倡議者把批評**指向該項規例**。

N. AIM TOWARDS / TOWARD

50. **aim towards/toward something — 朝某目標努力 / 朝某方向**

Practice 1

> The organisation is **aiming towards greater transparency**.

機構正**朝更高透明度努力**。

Practice 2

> The programme aims toward long-term independence.

計劃**以長遠自主為方向**。

MCQ-ready definition:

aim towards X = 把行動或發展方向指向 X

Usage note:

aim for is usually more natural for concrete goals.

O. AIM HIGH / AIM LOW

51. **aim high — 把目標定得高；志向遠大**

A major idiom.

Practice 1

> Students should **aim high**.

學生應該**把目標定高一點**。

Practice 2

> If you want to improve, aim high but remain realistic.

如果你想進步，可以**志向遠大**，但仍要保持現實。

MCQ-ready definition:

aim high = 為自己設定具挑戰性、較高的目標

52. **aim higher — 追求更高目標**

Practice 1

> The team met its target and decided to **aim higher**.

團隊達標後決定**追求更高目標**。

Practice 2

> Don't settle too early—aim higher.

不要太早滿足，應該**把目標再提高**。

53. **aim low** — 把目標定低；瞄低

Can be literal or figurative.

Practice 1 — figurative

> If you **aim too low**, you may never discover what you can achieve.

如果你把**目標定得太低**，可能永遠不知道自己的能力有多大。

Practice 2 — literal

> Aim slightly lower.

稍微瞄低一點。

Context determines the sense.

P. WELL-AIMED

54. **well-aimed** = accurately directed — 瞄得準的；針對得準確的

Practice 1

> A **well-aimed shot** hit the target.

一次**瞄得很準的射擊**擊中了目標。

Practice 2

> Her well-aimed criticism focused on the process rather than the person.

她那番**切中要害的批評**針對程序，而非個人。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****well-aimed = literal: 瞄準準確；figurative: 言論或行動針對得恰當****

55. ****well-aimed remark / criticism — 切中要害的說話 / 批評****

Practice 1

> His ****well-aimed remark**** exposed the weakness in the argument.

他一句****切中要害的話****指出了論點的弱點。

Practice 2

> The report contains some well-aimed criticism.

報告包含一些****針對得很準確的批評****。

Q. AIMLESS

56. ****aimless = without a clear purpose — 漫無目的的；沒有方向的****

The major negative derivative.

Practice 1

> The meeting became ****aimless****.

會議變得****沒有方向****。

Practice 2

> Without a clear objective, discussion can become aimless.

如果沒有清晰目標，討論可能變得****漫無目的****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****aimless = 沒有清晰目的、方向或計劃的****

57. **aimless conversation / discussion — 漫無目的的談話 / 討論**

Practice 1

> The meeting turned into an **aimless discussion**.

會議變成一場**沒有方向的討論**。

Practice 2

> Clear questions prevent aimless conversation.

清晰問題有助避免**漫無目的的談話**。

58. **aimless wandering — 漫無目的地遊蕩**

Practice 1

> He spent the afternoon in **aimless wandering** around the city.

他整個下午在城內**漫無目的地閒逛**。

Practice 2

> The character's aimless wandering reflects his uncertainty.

角色**漫無目的的遊蕩**反映他的迷惘。

59. **aimlessly — 漫無目的地**

Practice 1

> He walked **aimlessly** around the station.

他在車站附近**漫無目的地走來走去**。

Practice 2

> The discussion drifted aimlessly from one topic to another.

討論**毫無方向地**從一個話題轉到另一個話題。

60. **aimlessness** — 漫無目的；缺乏方向

Practice 1

> The project's early **aimlessness** caused confusion.

項目初期的**缺乏方向**造成混亂。

Practice 2

> Clear leadership reduced the sense of aimlessness.

清晰的領導減少了那種**漫無方向的感覺**。

R. SPECIALIST AIMING LANGUAGE

61. **aiming point** — 瞄準點

A useful technical term in shooting, aviation, optics, etc.

Practice 1

> The centre of the target is the **aiming point**.

靶的中央是**瞄準點**。

Practice 2

> The pilot adjusted the aiming point.

機師調整了**瞄準點**。

MCQ-ready definition:

aiming point = 進行瞄準時選定要對準的具體位置

62. **line of aim** — 瞄準線

More specialist but established.

Practice 1

> The sight helps establish the **line of aim**.

瞄準器有助確定**瞄準線**。

Practice 2

> The target must remain in the line of aim.

目標必須保持在**瞄準線**上。

Important distinction 1: **aim vs goal**

Very important.

aim

what someone intends and works towards.

goal

specific desired result, often more concrete/measurable.

> aim: improve teamwork

> goal: reduce project delays by 20%

In everyday English they overlap heavily.

Important distinction 2: **aim vs objective**

Especially relevant to your passage.

aim

broader desired purpose/direction.

objective

often more specific and measurable.

Example:

- > Aim: improve communication.
- > Objective: introduce weekly updates by October.

In many contexts they are interchangeable, but **objective** tends to sound more precise/formal.

Important distinction 3: **aim vs purpose**

purpose

why something exists or is done.

aim

what result you are trying to reach.

- > purpose of training = why it exists
- > aim of training = what it hopes to achieve

They often overlap.

Important distinction 4: **aim vs intention**

intention

what someone plans or means to do.

aim

desired result of that action.

- > intention: hold weekly meetings
- > aim: reduce confusion

So:

intention = planned action

aim = desired outcome

Important distinction 5: **aim vs ambition**

****aim****

any intended goal.

****ambition****

usually a strong, often major or long-term desire for achievement.

> aim to finish by Friday

> ambition to become CEO

Important distinction 6: ****aim vs target****

****target****

specific level/result to reach.

****aim****

broader goal.

> aim = increase sales

> target = increase sales by 10%

But ****target**** can also mean physical object being aimed at.

Important distinction 7: ****aim vs priority****

This is especially important in your paragraph.

****aim****

what result you want.

****priority****

what you consider most important and therefore deal with first.

The product team's:

> aim = launch successfully

> priority = speed

The compliance team's:

> aim = launch safely/compliantly

> priority = caution

The passage loosely refers to these differing **aims**, but conceptually aims and priorities are not identical.

Important distinction 8: **aim to** vs **plan to**

plan to

have a relatively concrete intention or arrangement.

aim to

intend and strive, without necessarily guaranteeing success.

> We plan to launch in June.

> 我們計劃六月推出。

> We aim to reduce errors by 20%.

> 我們力求減少百分之二十錯誤。

Important distinction 9: **aim to** vs **hope to**

hope to

want something to happen.

aim to

actively intend and work toward making it happen.

> hope to improve

> 希望改善

> aim to improve

> **力求改善**

****Aim**** implies more active purpose.

Important distinction 10: ****aim to vs try to****

****try to****

make an attempt.

****aim to****

set something as a goal before or during the effort.

> try to finish today

> 嘗試今天完成

> aim to finish today

> ****以今天完成為目標****

Important distinction 11: ****aim for vs aim to****

****aim for + noun****

> aim for higher quality

****aim to + verb****

> aim to improve quality

Same core meaning, different grammar.

Important distinction 12: ****aim at + noun/-ing****

Correct:

> aim at improvement

> aim at improving communication

Not normally:

> *aim at improve communication* ❌

Important distinction 13: **aim at vs aim for**

For abstract goals:

aim for

very natural and common.

> aim for growth

aim at

possible, slightly more formal:

> aim at improvement

For physical targeting:

> aim at the target

is the normal expression.

Important distinction 14: **be aimed at + audience vs be aimed at + result**

Two major uses:

Audience:

> The course is aimed at managers.

> 課程**為管理人員而設**。

Result:

> The course is aimed at improving communication.

> 課程**旨在改善溝通**。

Same construction, different semantic role.

Important distinction 15: **aim X at Y vs aim at Y**

aim X at Y

you have an object/message/product:

> aim the camera at the stage

> 把相機對準舞台

> aim the campaign at young people

> 把活動針對年輕人

aim at Y

subject itself aims:

> aim at the target

> 瞄準目標

Important distinction 16: **aim a product at vs market a product to**

From your previous **market** family:

aim a product at X

design/position it specifically for X.

market a product to X

actively promote/sell it to X.

Example:

> The product is aimed at students.

> 產品**定位給學生**。

> The company markets it to students online.

> 公司在網上**向學生推銷它**。

Important distinction 17: **aim remarks at vs speak to**

speak to someone

simply communicate with them.

aim a remark at someone

deliberately direct a particular comment at them, often:

- * critical,
- * sarcastic,
- * pointed.

Important distinction 18: **aim criticism at vs criticize**

criticize X

direct verb.

aim criticism at X

emphasizes the **direction/target** of the criticism.

- > She criticized management.
- > 她批評管理層。

- > She aimed most of her criticism at management.
- > 她把大部分批評**集中指向管理層**。

Important distinction 19: **aim literal vs figurative**

The literal physical image is:

point something at a target

From this comes the figurative structure:

direct effort toward a desired result

So:

- > aim a rifle at a target
- > 瞄準靶子

becomes metaphorically:

> aim your efforts at improving quality
> 把努力**指向改善質素這個目標**

Important distinction 20: **take aim vs take aim at figuratively**

Literal:

> take aim at the target
> 瞄準靶子

Figurative:

> the article takes aim at management
> 文章**把矛頭指向管理層**

The metaphor is highly productive.

Important distinction 21: **good aim vs good goal**

good aim

in physical targeting can mean accurate ability.

a good aim

in abstract goal context can mean a worthwhile objective, though this is less common than:

> a good goal / worthwhile aim.

Context matters.

Important distinction 22: **aim high**

This can mean:

Literal:

aim physically higher.

Figurative:

set ambitious goals.

The figurative sense is especially common.

Important distinction 23: **aimless vs pointless**

aimless

without direction or clear goal.

pointless

having no useful purpose/value.

> aimless walk

> 漫無目的的散步

> pointless argument

> 毫無意義的爭論

An aimless activity is not necessarily pointless—it may still be enjoyable.

Important distinction 24: **aimless vs random**

aimless

lacks purpose/direction.

random

lacks a deliberate pattern or selection method.

> aimless wandering

> 沒有目的地走

> random selection

> 隨機選擇

Not interchangeable.

Important distinction 25: **aimless vs unfocused**

aimless

no clear goal.

unfocused

may have a goal but lacks concentration or clear organization.

> aimless meeting

> 沒有目的

> unfocused meeting

> 主題不集中

Important distinction 26: **well-aimed**

A **well-aimed criticism** is not necessarily polite.

It means:

the criticism accurately targets the relevant weakness

So **well-aimed** describes precision, not kindness.

Important distinction 27: **aim vs direction**

direction

where something is moving or developing.

aim

why/what result it is trying to reach.

In your passage, teams can literally:

> proceed in different directions

because they have:

> differing aims.

Direction = pathway; aim = destination/purpose.

Important distinction 28: **aim vs outcome**

aim

desired result before action.

outcome

actual result after action.

> aim = reduce delays

> outcome = delays actually increased

The outcome may fail to match the aim.

Important distinction 29: **aim vs result**

Similarly:

> aim = intended result

> result = what actually happens.

A project can have a good aim but poor results.

Important distinction 30: **aim vs strategy**

aim

what you want to achieve.

strategy

how you plan to achieve it.

- > aim: improve customer satisfaction
- > strategy: shorten response times and train staff.

Important distinction 31: **aim vs method**

aim

destination/purpose.

method

specific way of working.

Two departments can share one aim but disagree completely about the method.

Important distinction 32: **aim vs mission**

mission

broad enduring purpose of an organisation.

aim

more specific goal, often for a project or period.

- > mission = improve public health
- > aim = reduce waiting times

Important distinction 33: **aim vs vision**

vision

desired long-term future state.

aim

more concrete goal pursued to move toward that vision.

Important distinction 34: **aim and objective in formal documents**

A common hierarchy is:

- > **overall aim** → broad intention
- > **objectives** → specific measurable steps/results

But organizations do not always use the terms consistently.

So never assume the hierarchy is universal.

Important distinction 35: **aim in your passage**

The passage says:

- > these differing **aims**

The product team and compliance team are not necessarily hostile.

Their desired outcomes simply emphasize different things:

Product team:

- > move quickly

Compliance team:

- > avoid regulatory/risk problems

The difficulty is:

different aims without good communication → conflicting decisions → delay

Family-extension note

The **aim** family has several major modern branches:

1. **goal / purpose**

- * main aim
- * common aim
- * long-term aim

2. **achieving goals**

- * achieve an aim
- * pursue an aim

3. **purpose construction**

- * with the aim of

4. **intention**

- * aim to do

5. **target result**

- * aim for X
- * aim at doing X

6. **designed purpose**

- * be aimed at improving

7. **target audience**

- * aimed at young people

8. **direct speech/criticism**

- * aim criticism at someone

9. **physical targeting**

- * aim a weapon
- * aim at a target

10. **take aim**

- * literal targeting

11. **figurative attack**

- * take aim at a policy

12. **ambition**

- * aim high
- * aim higher

13. **precision**

- * good aim
- * well-aimed

14. **lack of purpose**

- * aimless
- * aimlessly
- * aimlessness

15. **technical aiming language**

- * aiming point
- * line of aim

For your passage, the exact branch is:

aim = the particular result or priority that a team is trying to achieve

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----
aim (goal)	目標；目的	desired result
main aim	主要目標	principal goal
primary aim	首要目標	first priority
overall aim	整體目標	broad goal
ultimate aim	最終目標	final purpose
long-term aim	長期目標	future goal
short-term aim	短期目標	immediate goal
common aim	共同目標	shared purpose
shared aim	共同目標	same goal
stated aim	明示目標	formally declared
achieve an aim	達成目標	succeed
fulfil an aim	實現目標	accomplish
pursue an aim	追求目標	work toward
work towards an aim	朝目標努力	progress
with the aim of	旨在	purpose construction
aim to do X	力求 / 旨在做 X	intention
aim for X	以 X 為目標	desired result

aim at X	以 X 為目標	formal target	
aim at doing X	旨在做 X	purpose	
be aimed at doing X	旨在做 X	designed purpose	
be aimed at someone	為某人而設 / 針對某人	target audience	
aim a product at X	把產品定位給 X	customer targeting	
aim a remark at X	把說話針對 X	directed remark	
aim criticism at X	把批評指向 X	criticism target	
aim a weapon	瞄準武器	physical direction	
aim at a target	瞄準目標	targeting	
aim a camera	把相機對準	physical direction	
take aim	瞄準	prepare to shoot	
take aim at X	瞄準 / 抨擊 X	literal/figurative	
good aim	瞄得準	accuracy	
poor aim	瞄得不準	inaccuracy	
aim towards X	朝 X 努力	direction	
aim high	把目標定高	ambition	
aim higher	追求更高目標	greater ambition	
aim low	把目標定低 / 瞄低	low target	
well-aimed	瞄得準 / 切中要害	precise direction	
aimless	漫無目的的	no goal	
aimless discussion	沒有方向的討論	no clear purpose	
aimlessly	漫無目的地	without purpose	
aimlessness	缺乏方向	state	
aiming point	瞄準點	technical targeting	
line of aim	瞄準線	technical targeting	

For your original sentence

> For instance, a product team may push for speed, while the compliance team insists on caution; without proper communication, these differing ****aims**** can delay the entire project.

Here:

****aims** = 不同部門各自希望實現的結果或方向：產品團隊重視加快進度，而合規團隊重視降低風險和確保遵守要求

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 例如，產品團隊可能會力求加快進度，而合規團隊則堅持謹慎行事；如果缺乏適當溝通，這些不同的****目標 / 追求方向****可能會拖延整個項目。

The cleanest contrast is:

> ****aim**** = ****想達到甚麼結果****

- > **objective** = 較具體、常較可量度的目標
- > **priority** = 目前最重要、最先處理甚麼
- > **strategy** = 用甚麼方法達成目標
- > **outcome** = 最後實際發生甚麼

And for this paragraph specifically:

- > **product team's aim/priority** → speed
- > **compliance team's aim/priority** → caution
- > **shared organisational aim** → complete the project successfully

The real communication challenge is therefore not necessarily that either side has a “wrong” aim, but that **different immediate aims must be reconciled under one shared overall aim**.